Getting Started with Express.js

A Minimal and Flexible Node.js Web Application Framework



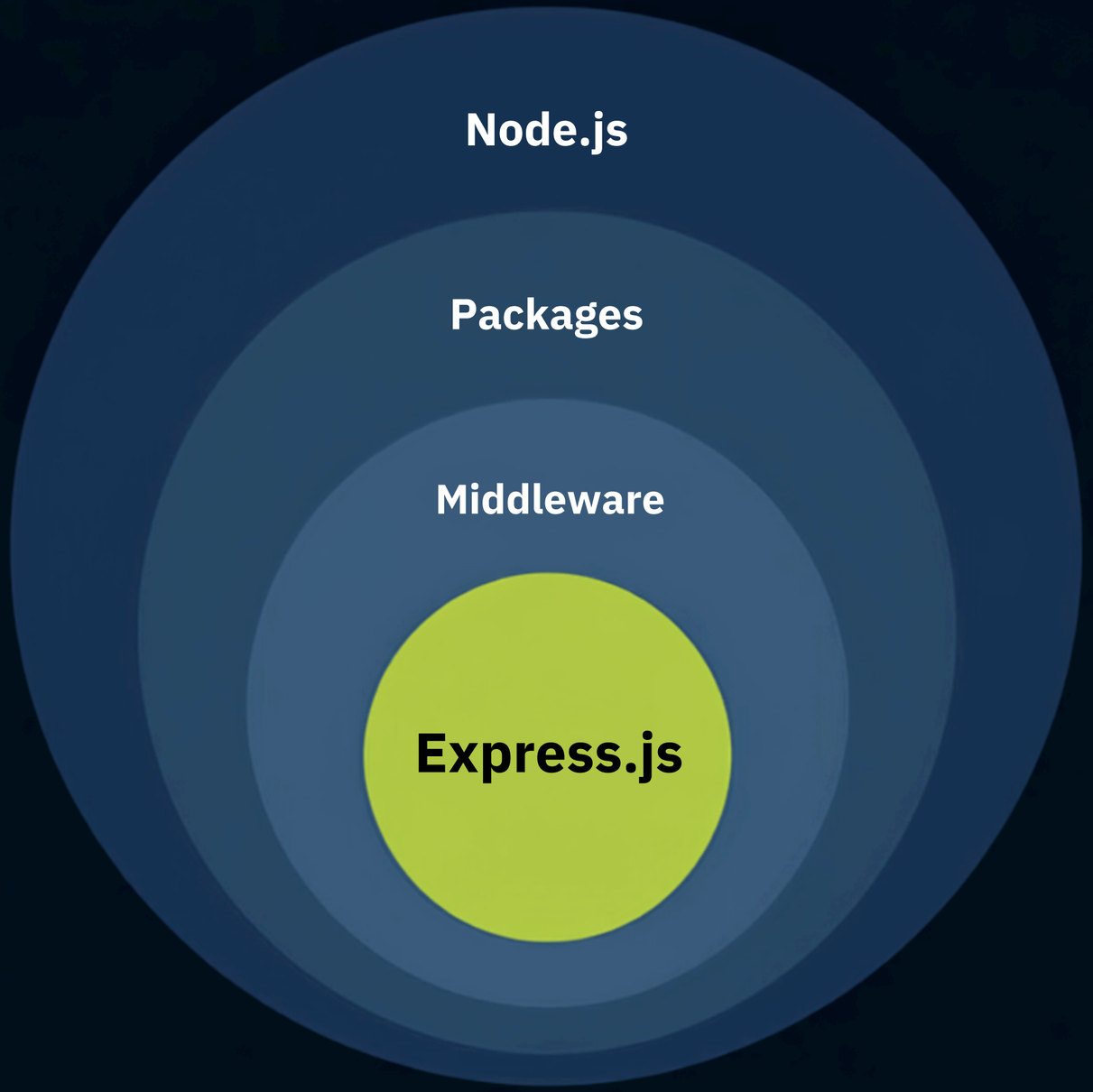
What is Express.js?

A minimal and flexible web framework for Node.js

Simplifies routing, middleware, and request handling

Built for speed and scalability

A top choice for modern backend JavaScript development



Key Features of Express.js

- **Routing System:** Easily maps specific URLs and HTTP methods (like GET, POST, PUT, DELETE) to target functions.
- **Middleware Support:** Allows you to insert functions into the request-response lifecycle to perform tasks like parsing JSON data, logging requests, handling authentication, or managing errors.
- **Minimalist Nature:** It provides only a thin layer of core web features. Rather than forcing a rigid structure, it leaves you free to choose your own database, folder architecture, and third-party plugins.
- **Database Integration:** It connects seamlessly with both SQL and NoSQL databases like MongoDB, MySQL, and PostgreSQL
- **Full-Stack Ecosystem:** It serves as the core backend component for popular JavaScript stacks, including MERN (MongoDB, Express, React, Node.js) and MEAN (MongoDB, Express, Angular, Node.js). [1]

Setting Up Express.js

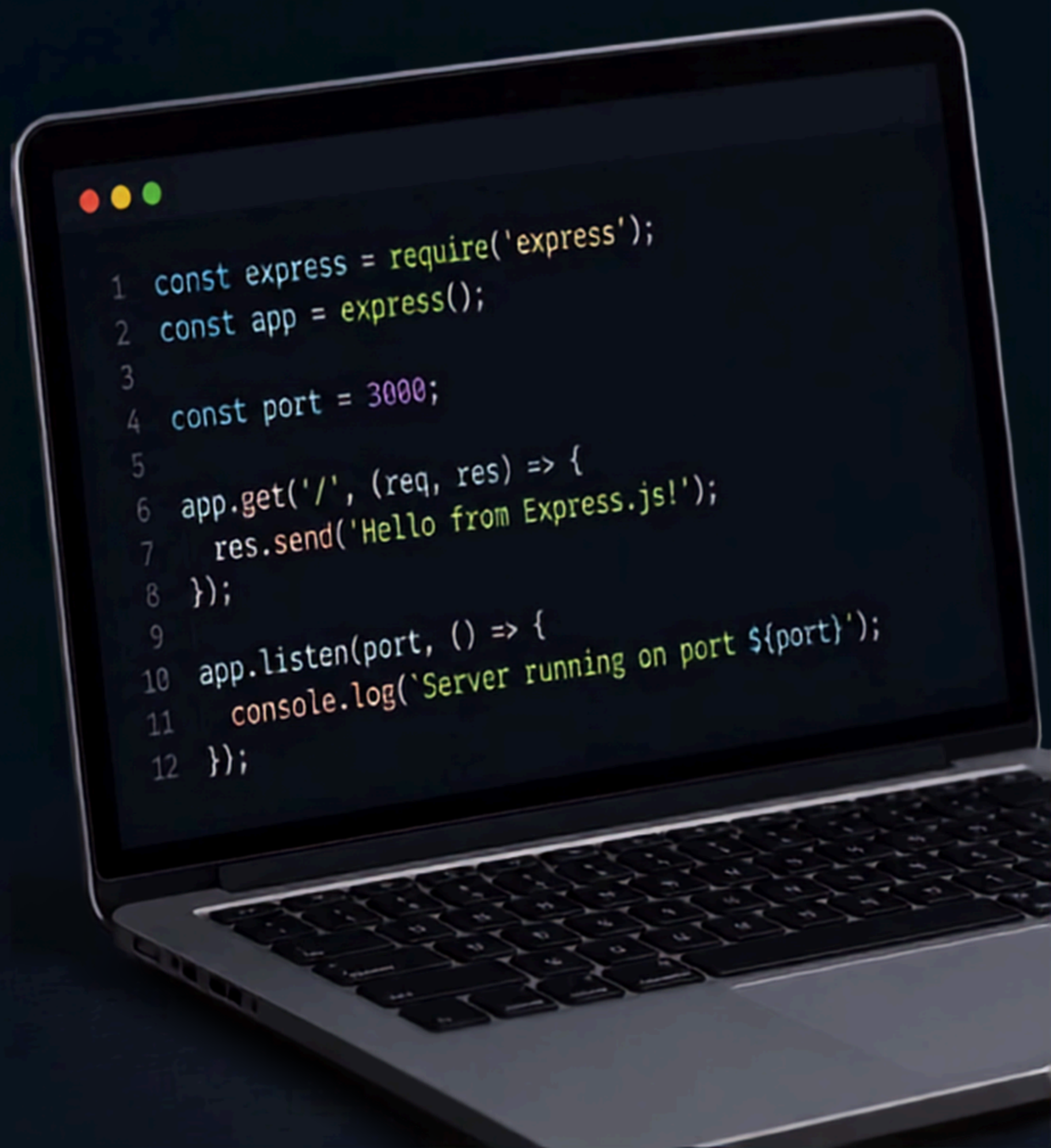
Install Node.js and npm

Initialize a new project with npm init

Install Express with npm install express

Create a basic server file (e.g., app.js)

Run the server with node app.js



Basic Express Server

Import Express and create an app instance

Define a **GET** route for the root path (/)

Send a response: **"Hello, Express!"**

Start the server and listen on port **3000**

